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Interest-free financing for higher education

EARLY-STAGE CONCEPT

STUDENT SUPPORT, WITH PURPOSE

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Students focus on their education, not on how to pay for it

01

University-integrated, Sharia-guided support

Overcome education-related financial barriers through an institutional, interest-free model.

02

Proactive continuity

Accompany students from their first semester through graduation, resolving balances early before registration holds become crises.

03

Protecting the student experience

Tuition pressure should never cost a student their campus standing, academic momentum, or decades of compound debt.

Early-stage thesis: institutional integration stops financial dropouts before registration holds trigger.

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Financial pressure can shape a student's whole path

Four anonymized profiles based on real experiences of New Jersey students from 2019 to 2025.

01

One Semester Away from Graduation

Final-semester tuition remained uncovered despite work and federal loans. Late fees delayed the diploma; the unpaid balance later went to collections.

02

A Dream of Medicine. A Conflict of Conviction.

Accepted to medical school without family support, this student faces high costs and interest-bearing loans that conflict with their faith.

03

A Family That Can Afford College — Just Not All at Once

Several siblings pursue college together, but upfront balances and short payment schedules make affordability and school choice difficult.

04

Working to Stay in School

Working to cover tuition and living costs leaves less time for academics; when income falls short, a student may stop out.

Junnah is a pre-validation concept; any future model depends on funding, an institutional partner, and appropriate legal, regulatory, financial, privacy, and qualified Sharia review.

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Shared mission, different constraints

Community nonprofits and Junnah seek to help students—but eligibility and available resources can shape who receives support.

01

Character-based assessments

Some programs consider character or other eligibility criteria. Students who do not meet those criteria may still face an urgent education balance.

02

Donation-dependent capacity

For donation-supported programs, available aid may not cover a student's full verified need. Funding levels and donor restrictions can affect how much support is available and when.

03

Lengthy reviews and separate paperwork

Some aid pathways can involve extended review and separate documentation. Junnah is exploring a school-connected intake that starts with one simple form and coordinates verification with the institution, while keeping human review.

04

A complementary pathway

Junnah is exploring a university-integrated model that could complement nonprofit aid and other resources—not replace them.

These are hypotheses to validate with nonprofit partners and students. Eligibility and funding models vary across organizations.

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Junnah is workflow infrastructure, not a chatbot or a loan marketplace

One connected system takes a student from shortfall to paid balance.

01

Identify the shortfall or new term.

02

University verifies amount and deadline

03

Human reviewer assesses circumstances

04

Student accepts documented, principal-only terms

05

Junnah pays the university directly each semester

06

Student tracks principal, repayment and hardship support

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Same balance, very different students

Three illustrative student profiles demonstrating why human review looks at real capacity rather than automated credit scores.

01

Profile A · Employed, with family

Earns part-time wages, but income is absorbed by essential household contributions. Living at home does not mean tuition liquidity exists.

Review insight: family co-residence does not equal tuition surplus.

02

Profile B · Employed, independent

Maintains consistent employment but carries full rent, utilities, food, and transit obligations. Zero discretionary margin remains for lump-sum term fees.

Review insight: high fixed living overheads exhaust earnings.

03

Profile C · Unemployed, with family

Zero earned income. Case management reviews household capacity and employment horizon rather than dismissing the student for lacking current payroll.

Review insight: requires assessing actual household support capacity.

Fictional profiles for review design. No standard automated algorithm captures non-discretionary family support obligations.

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Fair review and principal-only repayment build student trust

01

01 · Human accountability

No standard credit-score test; human reviewers stay accountable, with documented reasons and an appeal route.

02

02 · Qard Hasan structure

Students repay principal only; $4,000 at $100 a month is 40 months, illustrative.

03

03 · Structured hardship support

Deferment, reduced payments, periodic review.

04

04 · Proposed administration fee

Illustratively $25 per new contract, charged only if approved, never at submission and never added to principal; pending legal and Sharia review, not an approved term.

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Universities pay for software; investors share eligible company profit

01

Enterprise SaaS hypotheses · University revenue models

Institutions preserve retention by clearing administrative drops. Testing software subscriptions, onboarding implementation fees, administrative servicing fees, or volume tiers.

Unvalidated hypothesis: pricing models require pilot discovery.

02

Ethical investor return · Contractual profit participation

Investors hold rights strictly to eligible operating company profits. Investor returns never touch philanthropic donations or student principal repayments.

Returns are commercial, unguaranteed, and ring-fenced from student repayments.

University willingness to pay and exact SaaS contract amounts remain unvalidated hypotheses for pilot testing.

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Universities gain a structured path for unresolved balances

01

Retention and re-enrollment

A defined pathway for students blocked by balances. Effect on retention is to be measured with predicted higher retention and graduation rates.

02

Administrative efficiency

One place for intake, verification, review, status and reporting across departments.

03

Balance resolution

Approved cases paid directly to the university from the separate pool, subject to funding.

04

Reporting and accountability

Applications, decisions, amounts disbursed and processing times.

05

Preventing collections at source

Upfront tuition payment can address eligible balances before they enter collections and may reduce collection risk for supported cases.

Pricing and value are unvalidated and must be tested with each institution. Junnah will not eliminate collections in every case. The university pays for software and administration only, separate from charitable funds and student repayments.

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Three kinds of money stay strictly separate

A proposed tri-vault structure is intended to separate financial flows; Sharia compliance and regulatory integrity require qualified review.

01

Vault I · Charitable Pool / Student Financing

Philanthropic donations and institutional gifts fund student principal directly. Repayments recycle to future eligible students under the pool's rules.

Recycled capital; subject to default or forgiveness. Never guaranteed. Meant to serve as a Sadaqa Jariyah for donors.

02

Vault II · Operating Equity / Investor Capital

Funds software engineering, compliance, operations, team payroll, and revolving fund. Equity investors hold claims solely against operating company value.

Investors accept genuine business risk in exchange for a share of actual profits; they are not promised a fixed return, and student principal repayments remain entirely separate.

03

Vault III · Earned Revenue / University Contracts

Commercial software licenses and institutional servicing fees paid by university partners for workflow infrastructure and retention management.

Operating revenue stream sustaining the management company.

Sharia compliance checks needed here to evaluate under a mudarabah or musharakah structure.

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A one-semester pilot with about 10 students tests the real workflow

01

Scope

One New Jersey university, about 10 students, one semester.

02

Long-term vision

Support from a student's first semester through graduation; the pilot starts narrow.

03

Pilot pathways

Final-semester shortfall, registration barrier, graduation-clearance barrier; rent and living costs excluded.

04

Measures

Time to decision, amounts disbursed, barrier resolved, cost per case, hardship, university willingness to renew, retention rate, graduation rate.

05

Illustrative budget

Dependent on university tuition, software/ administration costs, and number of students in pilot.

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One coordinated experience across the support model

01

Student portal

02

Case management

03

University portal

04

Investor and donor dashboards

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Where we are, and what we want from a partner

01

Where we stand

Built from lived experience. Solo software-engineer founder at pre-validation concept stage. Zero institutional partners, formal funding, or commercial revenue yet.

02

What must be validated

Legal structure, formal Sharia advisory certification, and university willingness to pay software fees.

03

What we seek from partners

Model stress-testing, introductions to New Jersey higher education leadership, pilot advisory support, and early hiring alignment.

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